

Assignment No. 8

PHP Development Environment Setup Guide

PHP · Composer · Laravel · Node.js · php.ini

#01 Checking & Registering PHP

- 1 Open **Command Prompt** and run `php -v` to check if PHP is already available.
- 2 If unrecognised, open the **XAMPP** directory and go into the `php` folder.
- 3 Highlight and copy the full path from the File Explorer address bar.
- 4 Open **Environment Variables**: right-click *This PC* → Properties → Advanced System Settings.
- 5 Under *System Variables* click **New**, paste the path, then click **OK** to save.
- 6 Open a new Command Prompt and run `php -v` again to verify.
- 7 If nothing shows, verify the pasted path is correct and repeat from step 4.

#02 Installing Composer

- 1 Search **Composer PHP** in your browser and land on the official getcomposer.org page.
- 2 Go to the **Download** section and get the Windows setup executable.
- 3 Open the downloaded file and allow any permission prompts.
- 4 Click through the wizard pages and press **Finish** at the end.
- 5 Open Command Prompt and run `composer -v` to confirm it installed.
- 6 No response? Rerun the installer and ensure it finishes without errors.

#03 Installing Laravel

- 1 Open the **Laravel website** and locate the installation command in the docs.
- 2 Copy: `composer global require laravel/installer`
- 3 Run it in Command Prompt and wait for it to complete.
- 4 Create a folder called **my_app** on your Desktop.
- 5 Inside that folder, open Command Prompt by typing `cmd` in the address bar.
- 6 Run `laravel new my_app` to generate the project scaffold.

#04 Installing Node.js

- 1 Visit **nodejs.org** and download the recommended LTS build.
- 2 Run the installer and accept all permission requests.
- 3 Click **Next** through the setup wizard, then **Finish**.
- 4 Check the install with `node -v` and `npm -v` in Command Prompt.
- 5 Both should return version numbers. If not, reinstall and recheck.

#05 Enabling ZIP in php.ini

- 1 Open **php.ini** from your *XAMPP/php* directory in VS Code.
- 2 Press **Ctrl + F**, search for `extension=zip` (line ~962).
- 3 Delete the semicolon (`;`) at the start of that line.
- 4 Save the file and run `php -m` in Command Prompt.
- 5 Confirm *zip* appears in the output. Ensure PHP version is **8.2** if it doesn't.

Tip: This extension is only present in PHP 8.2. Upgrade XAMPP if you're on 8.0.

#06

Launching a New Laravel Project

- 1 In Command Prompt, go to **XAMPP/htdocs**.
- 2 Run `laravel new my_app` and answer prompts as below:
- 3 Starter kit → **None**
- 4 Testing framework → **0** (PHPUnit)
- 5 AI assistant → **No**
- 6 Database → **MySQL**
- 7 Run migrations → **Yes** | Skip npm script → **Yes**
- 8 Navigate into the project: `cd my_app`, then run `composer run dev`.
- 9 Open `localhost : 8000` in your browser to see the welcome screen.

Tip: Existing project? Open the project folder in cmd and run 'composer run dev' directly.